

Iodine

 53
I

This halogen was first discovered in seaweed, and is an essential nutrient in food. Iodine is also used in inks and dyes, as an antiseptic for cuts, and for purifying water. When heated, solid iodine does not melt but instead turns directly into a gas.

ATOMIC MASS 126.904

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1811
(Bernard Courtois)

*Solid iodine
turning into gas*

**Glass sphere containing
pieces of pure iodine and
iodine vapour**

Tennessine

 117
Ts

Discovered only in 2010, tennessine is the newest member of the periodic table. It is named after the state of Tennessee in the USA, which is home to the Oak Ridge National Laboratory – one of the first atomic research centres. Chemists think tennessine might be a semi-metal, unlike the other halogens.

ATOMIC MASS (294)

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 2010 (teams from Joint Institute for Nuclear Research, Dubna, Russia; Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory, California, USA; and Oak Ridge National Laboratory, Tennessee, USA)